

Rugby
16.1.17.



Dear Sir,

I am very grateful
to you for your kindness
in answering my
question so fully.

What you say with
its of great interest to
several boys who
objected strongly to
the reconstruction
but could not
explain why.

What you say makes
me think that
I had a larger
share in the work
than I thought

for you say that the
reconstruction expresses
what is certainly my
view - that thought
is so great that few
men have the strength
to be worthy of it and
that it is a tyrannic
master inspiring a
few men to freedom
but the majority to
a terror which is
their ruin if they do
not run away from
it. Our laughter at
Mrs Shelley's "Teach
him to think for
himself? Oh, my God!
Teach him to think
like other people" -

but can we deny
that thought leads
a man to a Sektarian
for which a mother
may well pray to
have a son delivered
"if it be possible?"

You say at the end that
you "are much honoured":
I know that this is a
conventional phrase
but it gives me great
pleasure. I often
have occasion to
speak of you to boys &
colleagues. You will
not be surprised to
hear that they often
show a remarkable
ignorance of the kind of
honour due to your
name!

Yours truly
W. O. Whistler.